



DANNY DWYER

BRANDING STYLE GUIDELINE

TYPEFACE

MAIN/BRAND: **FUTURA BOLD**

Video Titles: **Trade Gothic Bold No.2**

Descriptions: Trade Gothic Regular

The system in one line: Futura signs the work. Trade Gothic Bold puts it in lights. Trade Gothic Regular tells the story.

FUTURA BOLD

Role: Main / Brand Typeface. Logo, name, site headings.

Use: **ALL CAPS** for the name and logo; title case for section headings.

The story. Designed by Paul Renner in 1927, Futura was built from pure geometry: perfect circles, clean triangles, straight lines. Europe made it, but America made it famous. It sold Volkswagens on Madison Avenue, opened *2001: A Space Odyssey*, and in 1969 it went to the Moon on the plaque Apollo 11 left behind.

Why it's ours. Futura is composition in letter form. Every shape is placed with intention, the same way a frame is. It's cinematic, commercial, bold as all shit (a nod to rollers in the graf world), and timeless, which is exactly the range of the work. And it carries a personal connection: the typeface humans left on the Moon now signs the work of a cinematographer (wink-wink) who filmed America's return to it.

TRADE GOTHIC BOLD NO. 2

Role: Video titles and project names. Storefront-sign feel.

Use: **ALL CAPS** for project names.

The story. Designed by American Jackson Burke for Mergenthaler Linotype between 1948 and 1960, Trade Gothic was built like brick shit house ready to put the fuckin work in: newspapers, ads, labels, and signage across mid-century America. Burke drew each weight on its own, so they never matched perfectly, and designers have debated for decades whether that's a flaw or its charm.

Why it's ours. It's the work ethic in type form: sturdy, honest, first to show up and last to leave. It puts every project name on the marquee with the same steady confidence, whether it's a ticket to the Moon mission or a close friend's streetwear launch. Those imperfect weights echo a lesson from the very first film: the mistakes you make when you're young become your style later on.

TRADE GOTHIC REGULAR

Role: Descriptions, credits, captions, all reading text.

Use: Regular weight, standard width. Sentence case.

The story. Trade Gothic Regular is the everyday weight of Jackson Burke's family, the one that did the actual reading work in mid-century American print: newspaper stories, ad copy, labels, and the fine print people really read.

Why it's ours. It's where the stories live: the Gaga call, the busboy shifts, the camera snuck through in pieces. It's clean, honest, and easy on the eyes, so it never gets in the way. Paired with its bold sibling on the titles, it keeps the whole site speaking in one American voice. Easy on the eyes.

Important Notes: Condensed type reads slower in long paragraphs. Your descriptions are short, so No. 18 works. Just set it a size or two bigger than normal body text and give the lines a little extra breathing room. Keeps it easy on the eyes.

COLOR

Five colors. Three do the work. Two back em up.

The whole system in one line: Ink is the stage. Headlight is the voice. Barn Red is the name in lights. Gold means go. Shit Kicker finishes the job when needed.

THE PALETTE

Five colors. Three do the work. Two back them up.

				
CORE INK #081D23 The stage Background	CORE HEADLIGHT #FFF3B0 The voice Text, taglines, drop shades	CORE BARN RED #9E2A2B The name in lights Logo, with Headlight drop shade	SUPPORT OLYMPIC GOLD #E09F3E Means go Buttons, links, contact	SUPPORT SHIT KICKER #5C3B23 The leather & wood Panels, footer, light-version text

ON INK (the website)

DANNY DWYER

SOME REAL QUALITY SHIT

Descriptions sit in Headlight on Ink. Easy to read, never shows off.

CONTACT

SHIT KICKER PANEL

Cards, footer band, hover states.
Headlight text on top.

[Watch the full film →](#)

ON HEADLIGHT (the light version: print, PDFs, decks)

DANNY DWYER

Body text runs in Shit Kicker on Headlight. Warm, like an old diner menu.

Links and buttons switch to Barn Red →

Olympic Gold is decoration only here. Oxblood is retired.



decoration only

accent

text

THE CORE THREE

Ink (#081D23): Background

The stage. Everything sits on it.

Headlight (#FFF3B0): Text, taglines, drop shades

The voice. Anything meant to be read, plus the shadow that makes the name pop.

Barn Red (#9E2A2B): The name

DANNY DWYER in Futura Bold, always with the Headlight drop shade.

THE SUPPORTING TWO

These dudes come off the bench for specific jobs.

Olympic Gold (#E09F3E): Action

Buttons, links, and the contact button. If it's gold, it does something.

Shit Kicker (#5C3B23): The Warm Neutral

The leather and wood holding it all together. Used for special moments on the website: the featured project, the footer band, and the contact block. It's the body text color in the light version and the go-to deep neutral for print and merch and kickin ass.

The ratio on the website: mostly Ink, then Headlight, with Barn Red, Olympic Gold, and Shit Kicker as the smaller hits. If any accent starts taking over, pull it back.

FOR BOXES & PANELS

Night Shift (#12323B): Ink with the lights turned up a notch

Not a sixth color, just a slightly lifted version of the background.

For everyday boxes, use Night Shift. Gallery cards, the credits sidebar, and forms. It's barely there, so the boxes read as layers instead of colors, your footage stays the star, and Olympic Gold pops even harder on it.

For special moments, use Shit Kicker. One box at a time: a featured project on the homepage, the footer band, a pull quote, or the "Got a story worth telling?" contact block. It's warm, it pops hard against the cool Ink, and it grabs attention.

Why not Shit Kicker everywhere? Repeated, it gets heavy you can only kick so much ass without taking a beer break. Fifty brown project cards would fight your thumbnails and make the page feel muddy, and Gold pops less on brown than on teal.

The rule: Night Shift for everyday, Shit Kicker for special. If everything is special, nothing is.

THE SIGNATURE TREATMENT

Barn Red letters, with a hard Headlight drop shade, on Ink.

- **The shade:** Headlight, hard edge, ZERO blur. Offset down and to the right at about 37°, with a distance of roughly one-eighth of the letter height.
- **Reference:** on the 2560 px banner, that's 20 px right and 15 px down.
- **Big sizes only:** logos, banners, and hero titles. Barn Red never appears as small text on Ink.
- **The shade is part of the logo.** Never use the Barn Red name on Ink without it.

THE LIGHT VERSION

For print, PDFs, decks, treatments, and anywhere outside of this guide, a light background is required.

- **Background:** Headlight
- **Body text:** Shit Kicker
- **Headings and the name:** Ink or Barn Red
- **Links and buttons:** Barn Red
- **Olympic Gold:** decoration only, since it's too light to read on Headlight

RUN-INS & THE BACKUP PLAN

1. Text over video or photos

The problem: Headlight text disappears over bright footage.

The plan: Put an Ink overlay behind the text at 60–80% opacity, or a gradient that fades up from the bottom. Never place text directly on raw footage.

2. Printing (business cards, one-sheets, merch)

The problem: Big dark backgrounds print muddy and never match the screen.

The plan: Use the light version, or keep the Ink but get a printed proof first. Ask your printer for CMYK or Pantone matches of all five colors.

3. Client and partner logos (Google, PUMA, ELLE, Twin Turbo)

The problem: Their brand colors clash with yours.

The plan: Show them as single-color Headlight logos on Ink. If a client requires full color, place the logo on a small Headlight tile.

4. Error messages and alerts (like the contact form)

The problem: Barn Red text on Ink is too dark to read.

The plan: Use a Barn Red box with Headlight text inside.

5. Color-blind visitors

The problem: Some people can't tell the accents apart by color.

The plan: Never rely on color alone. Underline links, and give buttons a clear shape or border.

6. Email clients and phones with auto dark mode

The problem: Some apps flip your colors automatically.

The plan: Keep emails simple, put the logo in as an image, and send yourself a test on iPhone and Gmail before any big send.

7. YouTube and social thumbnails

The problem: Ink-heavy thumbnails blend into YouTube's dark mode.

The plan: Lead with the footage. Use Headlight or Olympic Gold for text, and keep the Ink to a thin frame or text box.

8. Barn Red and Shit Kicker side by side

The problem: They're close in darkness, so they can blur together at small sizes.

The plan: Never put Barn Red directly on a Shit Kicker panel. Use Headlight or Olympic Gold on Shit Kicker instead.

LOGOS



THE BOLT

Before the camera, there was the power. My career started on the lighting and grip side, as a grip and gaffer: running cable, hanging lights, and making electricity work for the picture. That's where the bolt comes from. From there came the move to camera, no film school, and then everything, every last dollar, went into a camera.

The bolt splits the two Ds the way that first spark split life into before and after. It's the jolt that turned a crew member into a filmmaker. It's Barn Red because it's the same fire that runs through the name. And read it again: **D/D**. Director / DP. Danny Dwyer. The slash is the spark.

COLOR VERSIONS

- **Primary:** Headlight Ds and a Barn Red bolt, on Ink.
- **Light version:** Ink or Shit Kicker Ds and a Barn Red bolt, on Headlight.
- **One-color:** all Headlight on Ink, or all Ink on Headlight, for embroidery, engraving, stamps, and watermarks.

WHERE IT LIVES

- **Favicon and browser tab**
- **Profile pictures:** YouTube, Instagram, Vimeo, LinkedIn
- **Video bug:** a small watermark in the corner of footage, using the one-color Headlight version
- **End cards and title cards**
- **Merch:** hats, patches, stickers, tees
- **Gear:** camera stickers, case labels, slates
- **Business card backs and email signatures**

WHERE IT DOESN'T

- **Not as a replacement for the full name** where someone is meeting you for the first time, like the website header, banner, pitch decks, or invoices. The monogram is shorthand for people who already know the name.
- **Not on Twin Turbo materials.** It's your personal mark, and Twin Turbo gets its own.
- **Not in Olympic Gold.** Gold means action, and the bolt is identity.
- **No drop shade.** The shade belongs to the full name. The monogram stays flat and clean.
- **No stretching, rotating, re-angling the bolt, or swapping the Ds.**
- **Never split it up.** No Ds without the bolt, and no bolt without the Ds.
- **Never directly on busy footage.** Place it on an Ink tile, or use the one-color watermark version.

SPACING & SIZE

- **Clear space:** keep empty space around the mark equal to at least half the height of one D.
- **Minimum size:** 32 px for the full mark on screens, and about 0.5 inch in print.
- **Small-size version:** for the 16 px browser favicon, have your designer make a version with a **thicker bolt**. At that size, the current bolt disappears, and the D/D just reads as two letters.